

Absolutely — **overnight** is a strong target because your passage uses it figuratively:

> “her love of growing things did not appear **overnight**.”

Here **overnight** does **not** literally mean “during one night.” It means:

> **suddenly / in a very short time, without gradual development**

Word family: **overnight**

Base word: overnight

Part of speech / function: adverb (副詞) / adjective (形容詞) / noun-related fixed uses (名詞相關固定用法)

Overnight has essentially no useful derivational family. Its richness comes from a few genuinely distinct time-related meanings plus figurative extensions.

Meaning in your passage: **overnight** = suddenly / in a very short time — 一夜之間；突然；不是一下子形成的

Your sentence:

> “Her love of growing things did not appear **overnight**.”

Here, **overnight** means:

> **her interest in plants did not suddenly develop all at once; it had existed and grown gradually over many years.**

繁體中文：

不是在極短時間內突然形成，而是經過一段時間逐漸發展

Natural translation:

> “Her love of growing things did not appear overnight.”

「她對種植的喜愛並不是一夜之間突然形成的。」

So here:

> **not happen overnight** = 不是一下子就形成 / 發生的

1. **overnight = during the night (時間) — 在夜間；一夜之間**

The basic literal adverb meaning.

Practice 1

> “It rained heavily **overnight**.”

「昨夜 / 夜間**下了很大的雨**。」

Practice 2

> “The temperature dropped sharply **overnight**.”

「氣溫**在一夜之間 / 夜間**大幅下降。」

****overnight = 在一個夜晚的時間內發生****

2. **overnight = for the whole night / until the next morning — 過夜；整晚**

A related but distinct duration use.

Practice 3

> “We stayed **overnight** at a small hotel.”

「我們在一家小酒店**住了一晚 / 過夜**。」

Practice 4

> “Leave the seeds in water **overnight**.”

「把種子放在水裡**浸一整晚**。」

****overnight = 某件事情持續一整夜，直到第二天早上****

3. **overnight = suddenly / very quickly (比喻) — 一夜之間；突然；很快**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 5 — Original

> “Her love of growing things did not appear **overnight**.”

「她對種植的喜愛**並不是一夜之間突然形成的**。」

Practice 6

> “You cannot become an expert **overnight**.”

「你不可能**一夜之間 / 一下子**就變成專家。」

Practice 7

> “The business did not become successful overnight.”

「這間公司並不是**一下子就成功的**。」

overnight — figurative = 在極短時間內突然完成、形成或改變，彷彿只用了一個晚上

This often appears in negative statements:

- * not happen overnight
- * not change overnight
- * not become successful overnight

4. **overnight** + noun (夜間發生 / 持續的) — 夜間的；過夜的

Now **overnight** is an adjective.

Practice 8

> “The plants suffered damage from an **overnight frost**.”

「植物受到**夜間霜凍**損害。」

Practice 9

> “We booked an **overnight stay**.”

「我們預訂了**一晚住宿 / 過夜住宿**。」

overnight + noun = 在夜間發生、持續一晚或涉及過夜的

Common:

- * overnight stay
- * overnight flight
- * overnight train
- * overnight frost
- * overnight guest

5. **overnight + transport (交通) — 夜班 / 通宵的**

A useful travel branch of #4.

Practice 10

> “We took an **overnight train**.”

「我們坐了**夜班 / 通宵火車**。」

Practice 11

> “She booked an overnight flight to London.”

「她預訂了一班**夜間 / 通宵航班**去倫敦。」

overnight transport = 在夜間行駛並通常跨越一晚的交通服務

6. **overnight = become famous/successful suddenly — 一夜成名 ; 突然成功**

A common figurative pattern.

Practice 12

> “The singer became famous **overnight**.”

「那位歌手**一夜成名**。」

Practice 13

> “The product seemed to become a success overnight.”

「那件產品看起來像是**一夜之間突然成功**。」

overnight = 在非常短時間內突然獲得名聲、成功或重大變化

This belongs to the broader “suddenly/very quickly” sense, so I would not split it into a separate lexical meaning.

7. **overnight success (成功) — 一夜成名 / 突然成功的人或事物**

A common lexicalized phrase.

Practice 14

> “The actor was described as an **overnight success**.”

「那位演員被形容為**一夜成名的人**。」

Practice 15

> “The app looked like an overnight success, but the team had worked on it for years.”

「這個應用程式看起來像是**突然成功**，但團隊其實已經做了多年。」

overnight success = 表面上看似在極短時間內突然成功的人 / 事物

Often used ironically, because many “overnight successes” actually involve years of prior work.

8. **overnight delivery/shipping (物流) — 隔夜送達 ; 翌日送達**

A useful business/logistics compound.

Practice 16

> “The company offers **overnight delivery**.”

「這家公司提供**隔夜 / 翌日送達服務**。」

Practice 17

> “We paid extra for overnight shipping.”

「我們額外付費使用**隔夜配送 / 翌日送達**。」

overnight delivery = 貨物通常在下一個工作日 / 早上前送達的快速配送服務

This is especially common in American English.

9. **overnight bag** (旅行) — 過夜袋；一晚用旅行袋

Practice 18

> “She packed an **overnight bag**.”

「她收拾了一個**過夜旅行袋**。」

Practice 19

> “He only brought a small overnight bag.”

「他只帶了一個小型**一晚用旅行袋**。」

overnight bag = 裝一晚住宿所需基本物品的小型旅行袋

10. **overnight guest** (住宿) — 留宿一晚的客人

Practice 20

> “We had two **overnight guests**.”

「我們有兩位**留宿一晚的客人**。」

Practice 21

> “The room is prepared for overnight guests.”

「房間已為**過夜客人**準備好。」

overnight guest = 在某處住一晚的訪客

Important distinction: **overnight** vs **at night**

at night

= generally during nighttime.

> “I study at night.”

「我晚上讀書。」

overnight

= during one particular night / throughout the night / until next morning.

> “I worked overnight.”

「我通宵工作。」

So:

at night = 晚上這個時段

overnight = 跨越一整晚 / 某個晚上之內

Important distinction: **overnight vs all night**

all night

explicitly emphasizes the entire duration.

> “She studied all night.”

「她整晚讀書。」

overnight

can mean:

* during the night;

* for the night;

* until next morning.

> “She stayed overnight.”

「她留宿了一晚。」

Not always identical.

Important distinction: **overnight vs suddenly**

suddenly

= abruptly, with little warning.

overnight

figuratively =
over a very short period, often implying rapid transformation.

> “The weather changed suddenly.”

「天氣突然改變。」

> “The company did not become successful overnight.”

「公司不是一下子就成功。」

Overnight often emphasizes **speed of development**, not abruptness at one exact moment.

Important distinction: **overnight** vs **immediately**

You already curated **immediately**.

immediately

= with no delay.

> “She replied immediately.”

「她立刻回覆。」

overnight

= within a very short period, metaphorically perhaps one night.

> “Her confidence did not change overnight.”

「她的自信不是一夜之間改變的。」

So:

immediately = 馬上開始 / 發生

overnight = 在極短的一段發展時間內

Important distinction: **overnight vs over night**

Normally:

> **overnight** 

is one word for the meanings above.

Over night as two words is usually only used when **over** and **night** belong to separate grammatical roles in a larger phrase, which is much less common.

For learners:

> overnight = standard spelling

Important distinction: **overnight success vs instant success**

overnight success

often focuses on the appearance that success arrived extremely quickly.

instant success

means something was successful immediately from the beginning.

> “The new product was an instant success.”

= 一推出就成功。

> “She became an overnight success.”

= 她彷彿一夜成名。

Subtle but useful.

Family-extension sweep

Overnight has a compact family. Its learning value is mainly in these functions:

* **overnight** — during the night = 夜間

* **overnight — for the whole night** = 過夜 / 整晚
 * **overnight — figurative** = 一夜之間 / 突然
 * **overnight + noun** = 夜間的 / 過夜的
 * **overnight train/flight** = 夜班 / 通宵交通
 * **overnight success** = 一夜成名 / 突然成功
 * **overnight delivery** = 隔夜 / 翌日送達
 * **overnight bag** = 過夜旅行袋
 * **overnight guest** = 留宿一晚的客人

This is a good example of a word that is **useful but semantically compact**. We do not need to manufacture a dozen fake meanings.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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overnight — during the night	在某一夜間的時間內發生
overnight — for the whole night	某事情持續整晚直到第二天早上；過夜
overnight — figurative	在極短時間內突然形成、完成或改變；一夜之間
overnight + noun	在夜間發生、持續一晚或涉及留宿的
overnight transport	在夜間行駛並通常跨越一晚的交通服務
overnight success	表面上看似在極短時間內突然獲得成功 / 名聲
overnight delivery	貨物在下一日 / 一夜之後快速送達的配送服務
overnight bag	裝一晚住宿所需基本物品的小型旅行袋
overnight guest	在某個地方留宿一晚的訪客

For your original sentence

> “Her love of growing things did not appear **overnight**.”

The exact meaning is:

overnight = 在極短時間內突然形成；一夜之間

So:

> **did not appear overnight**

= **「並不是一下子 / 一夜之間突然形成的」**

Natural full translation:

> **「她對種植的喜愛並不是一夜之間突然出現的，而是多年來逐漸形成、一直存在的。」**

The key contrast is:

- > ****literally overnight**** → 在一夜之間 / 過夜
- > ****figuratively overnight**** → 在極短時間內突然發生
- > ****not happen overnight**** → 不是一下子就能形成 / 完成的